

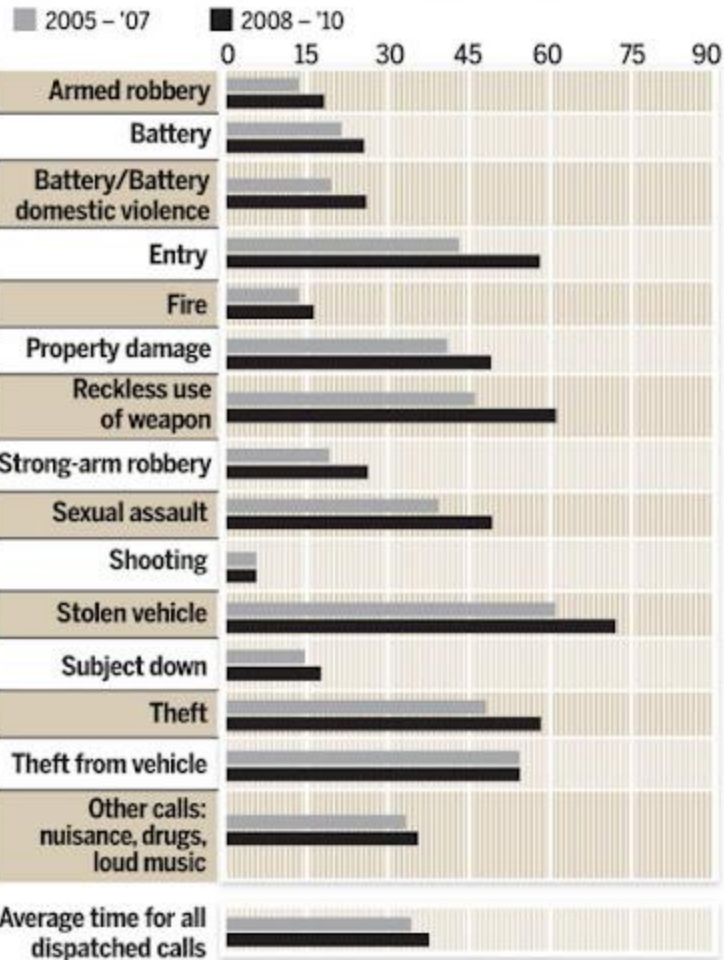


Is
9/11
a joke in your
town?

Milwaukee police response time slower since 2005

The Milwaukee Police Department's overall response time was 3.5 minutes longer on average in the three full years since Police Chief Edward Flynn's arrival than in the three years prior. Flynn has said slower response times are a result of shifting the department's priorities to proactive policing in high-crime areas and away from a focus on rapid response to calls.

3-year average police response times in minutes



@bposton

Ben Poston analyzed police response times in Milwaukee



Pricey home is no guarantee of a quick rescue

By KATY LUTHELMAN,
 Ben Welsh
 and ROBERT J. LOPEZ
 Los Angeles Times

While the 911 medical call times are generally fast across Los Angeles and many of the city's most exclusive neighborhoods have the longest response times, according to a Times investigation.

Under national standards set by the Los Angeles Fire Department, fire crews are supposed to arrive within 10 minutes of a dispatched emergency. But the Times analysis found that in affluent neighborhoods stretching from Griffith Park to Pacific Palisades, firefighters failed to get there nearly 60% of the time.

In several instances, the fire department's response times were so slow that residents in some of the city's most expensive neighborhoods had to wait more than 10 minutes for help.

The Times investigation is the first independent, data-driven analysis of how long it takes LAPD to respond to 911 calls.

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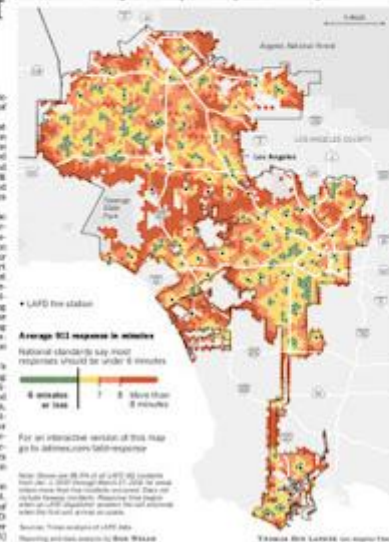
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How fast is the LAPD where you live?

Residents are expected to arrive in nearly all 911 calls within six minutes, a national standard. Los Angeles Fire Department leaders concede they regularly fail to meet. The Times analysis found more than 1 million calls by the Fire Department over the last five years and found that what firefighters can expect often depends on where they live.



For an interactive version of this map go to latimes.com/latresponse

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Romney blames loss on Obama 'gifts'

He says the president gave 'a lot of stuff' in his first term to young people and minorities to secure their votes.

By MAURE BEAVER

MIT Romney said Wednesday that his loss to President Obama was in large part to his media strategy of giving "gifts" during his first term to young people and minorities to secure their votes.

"The Obama campaign was following the old playbook of giving a lot of stuff in exchange for their support. They could get to vote for them and be motivated to go out to the polls, specifically that African American community, the Hispanic community and young people," Romney told hundreds of donors during a fundraising event Wednesday. "In each case they were very generous in what they gave to each of these groups."

Romney's blunt analysis echoed the recently leaked transcripts of a May 2009 speech, where he told a small group of donors that 60% of the electorate was "entirely new" to the political system. He said the Obama campaign had paid no income taxes and were dependent on government. He also said the Obama campaign had paid no income taxes and were dependent on government.

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EGYPT SHIFTS ISRAEL'S FOOTING ON GAZA

By BENJAMIN SCHWARTZ

JERUSALEM — Israel's rejection of a recent Egyptian proposal to build a new military base in the Gaza Strip is a move that could shift the footing of the "Arab Spring."

Compared with the previous campaign against Hamas, Israel's strategy had been more restrained politically and militarily in the new landscape.

Earlier than being able to control the Gaza Strip, Israel's strategy had been more restrained politically and militarily in the new landscape.

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CIA scandal figure led lavish lifestyle

A wealthy self-proclaimed CIA operative who lived in a \$10 million mansion in the Hamptons, owned a private jet and had a long-term relationship with a CIA official, a former CIA operative, has been accused of leading a lavish lifestyle. The man, who is now a CIA operative, has been accused of leading a lavish lifestyle. The man, who is now a CIA operative, has been accused of leading a lavish lifestyle.

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A Kenyan cyber-revolutionary

Official cultivates a "Silicon Savannah" that even offers an iCow app



A CYBER CAFE in Nairobi, Kenya. There are more than 20 million Internet users in this East African country of 40 million.

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@palewire

Ben Welsh analyzed fire and medical response times in L.A.

<http://www.latimes.com/lafddata>

PENGUIN
BOOKS

**WHAT WE TALK ABOUT
WHEN WE TALK ABOUT
RESPONSE TIMES**

BEN WELSH

COMPLETE



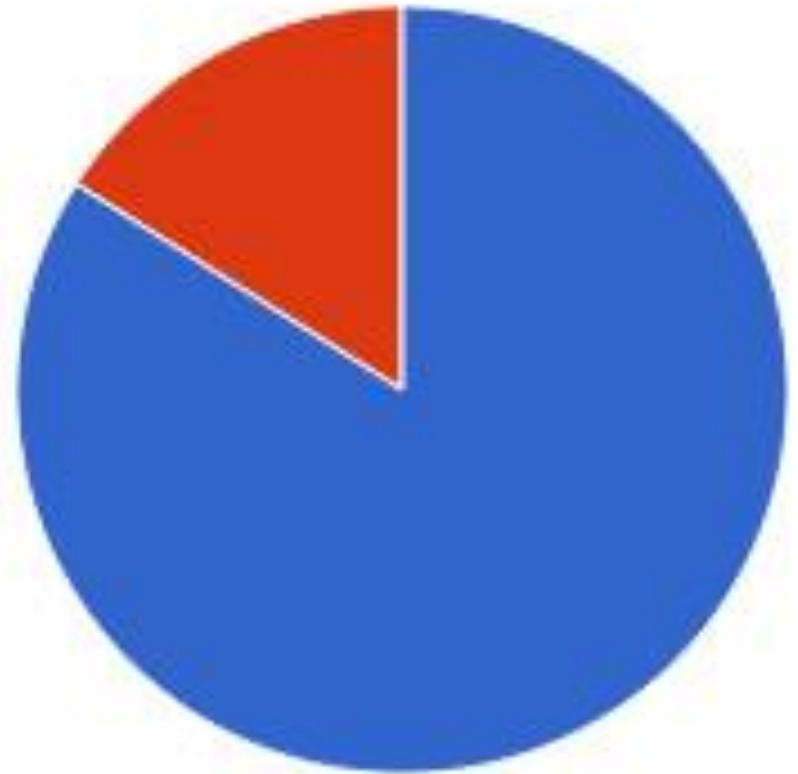
UNABRIDGED

50c

WHAT FIREFIGHTERS REALLY DO

- More than 80% of LAFD responses are medical
- Media coverage and fire department PR tend to focus on fires
- Extremely long calls get good anecdotal coverage, but full system rarely analyzed

Fire vs. **medical** responses at LAFD



(This pie contains real data!)

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Los Angeles TimesHospitals
targeted
by union
proposalsMICHAEL J. MISHAK
REPORTING FROM
SACRAMENTO

As healthcare workers gathered outside California hospitals recently to collect signatures for two proposed ballot initiatives, they told voters the measures would rein in excessive hospital billings and expand healthcare for the poor.

Unspoken in the public pitch was the fact that the measures, backed by the Service Employees International Union and aimed at private hospitals, would have a major effect on facilities the union has tried unsuccessfully to organize, while exempting those where many of its members work.



DON BARTLETT/Los Angeles Times

SERENE HAVEN has helped Donald Gentry, 57, hugging his daughter Donasia, 9, on the front lawn of their apartment complex. Gentry, a former Marine, was homeless for many years.

An ally for homeless vets

Politics
lights
a fire
under
LAFD

A mayoral hopeful unwittingly exposes overstated emergency response times.

KATE LINTHICUM

A Los Angeles mayoral candidate took an early campaign swipe at his leading opponents this week and inadvertently exposed the city Fire Department for publishing misleading performance data.

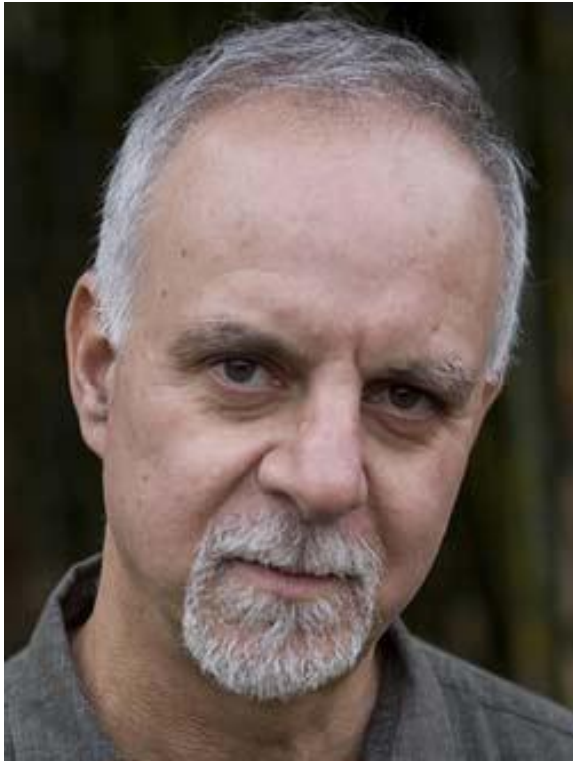


A layman's definition

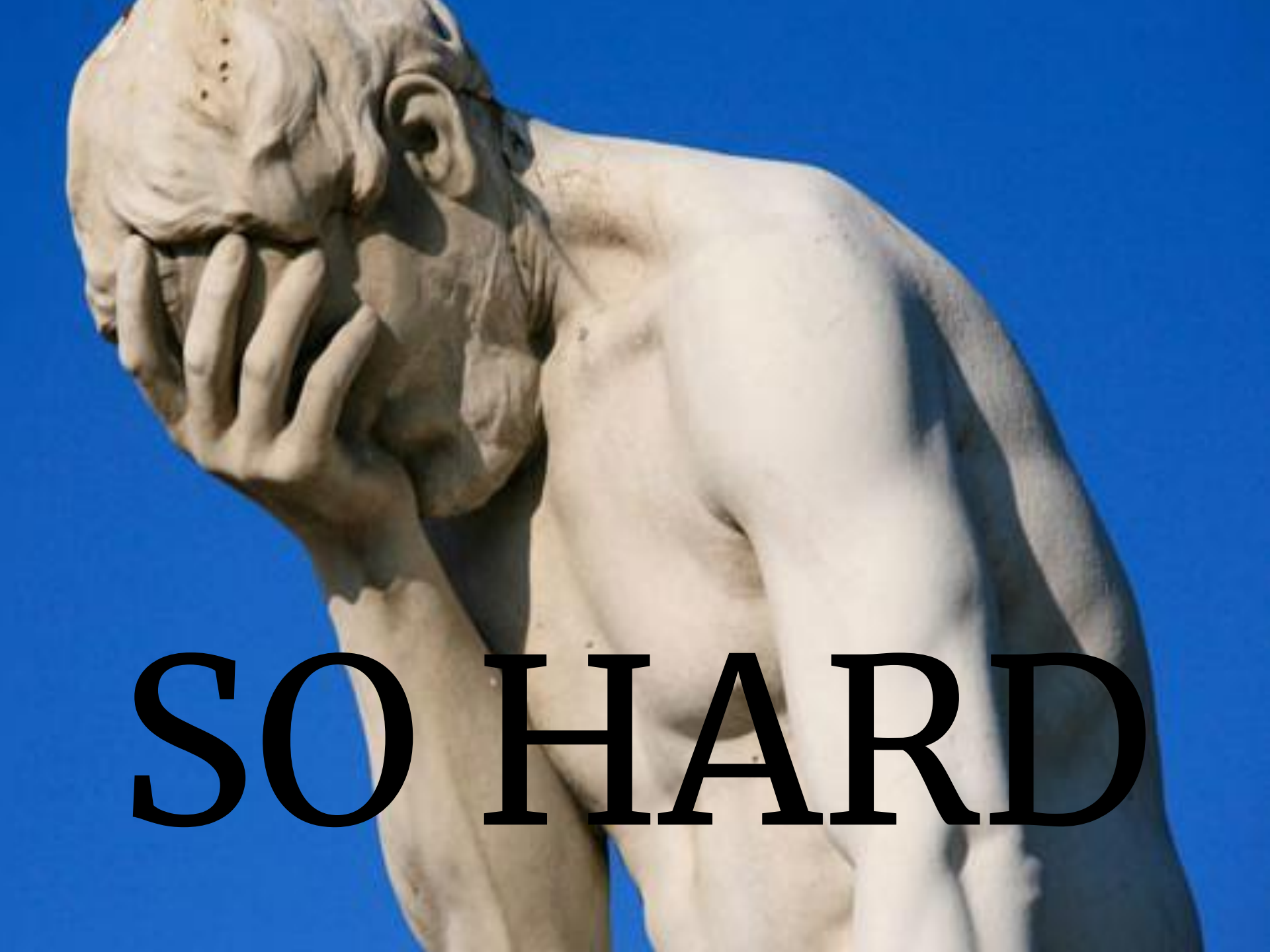
How long it takes from when you dial 911 until a rescuer arrives at the scene.



HOW HARD
CAN THIS
BE?



STEVE LOPEZ
@latimes columnist

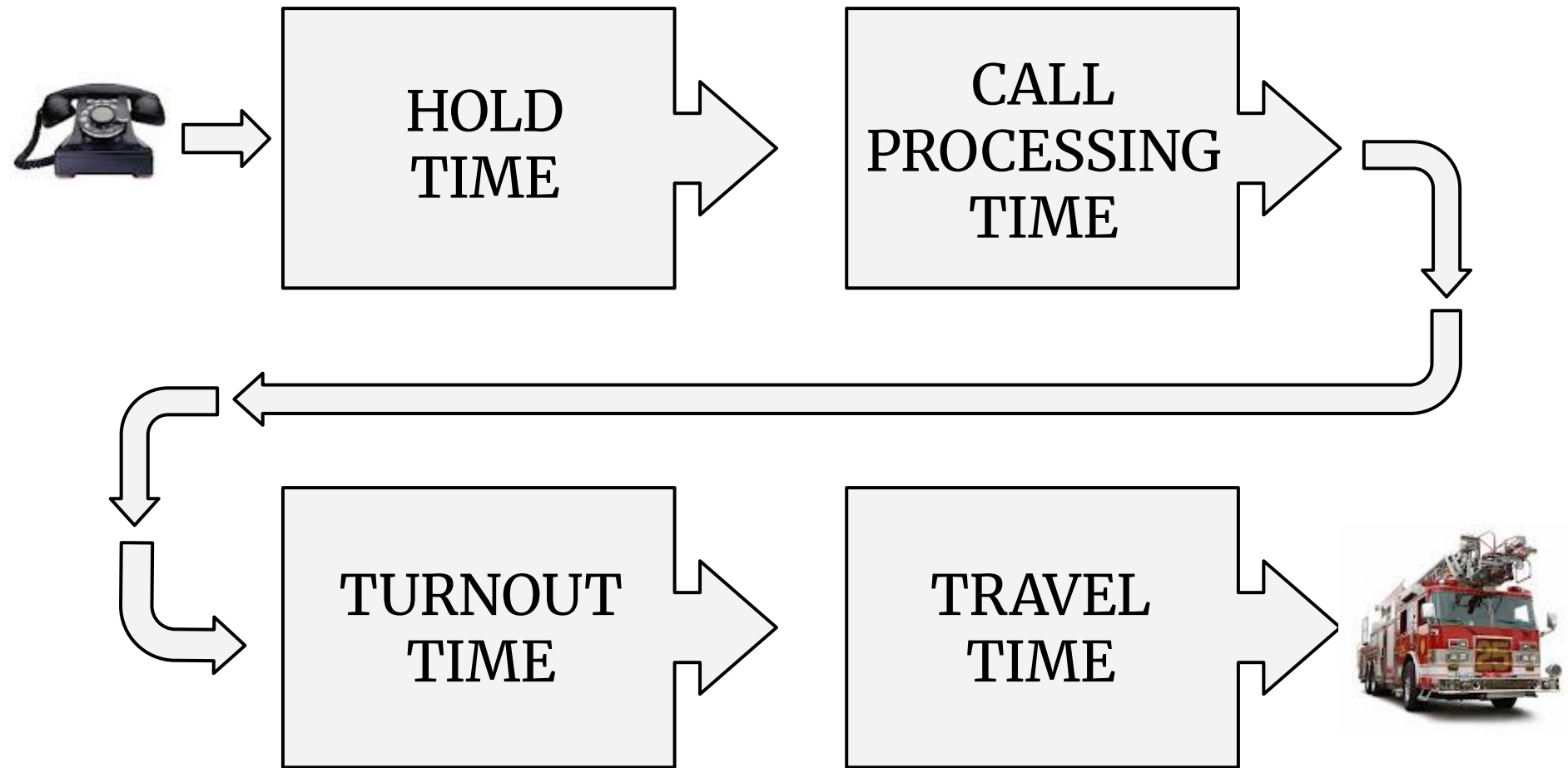


SO HARD

WHY

- Your call is passed between different departments.
- Each can have its own database, analytics, politics.
- Often, nobody responsible for tracking the whole thing.
- People who could have few incentives, little training.

A SIMPLIFIED VERSION



HOLD TIME

- How long it takes for a dispatcher to pick up the 911 call.



CALL-PROCESSING TIME

- How long it takes the dispatcher to log the incident and send help.



TURNOUT TIME

- How long it takes rescuers to suit up and get ready.

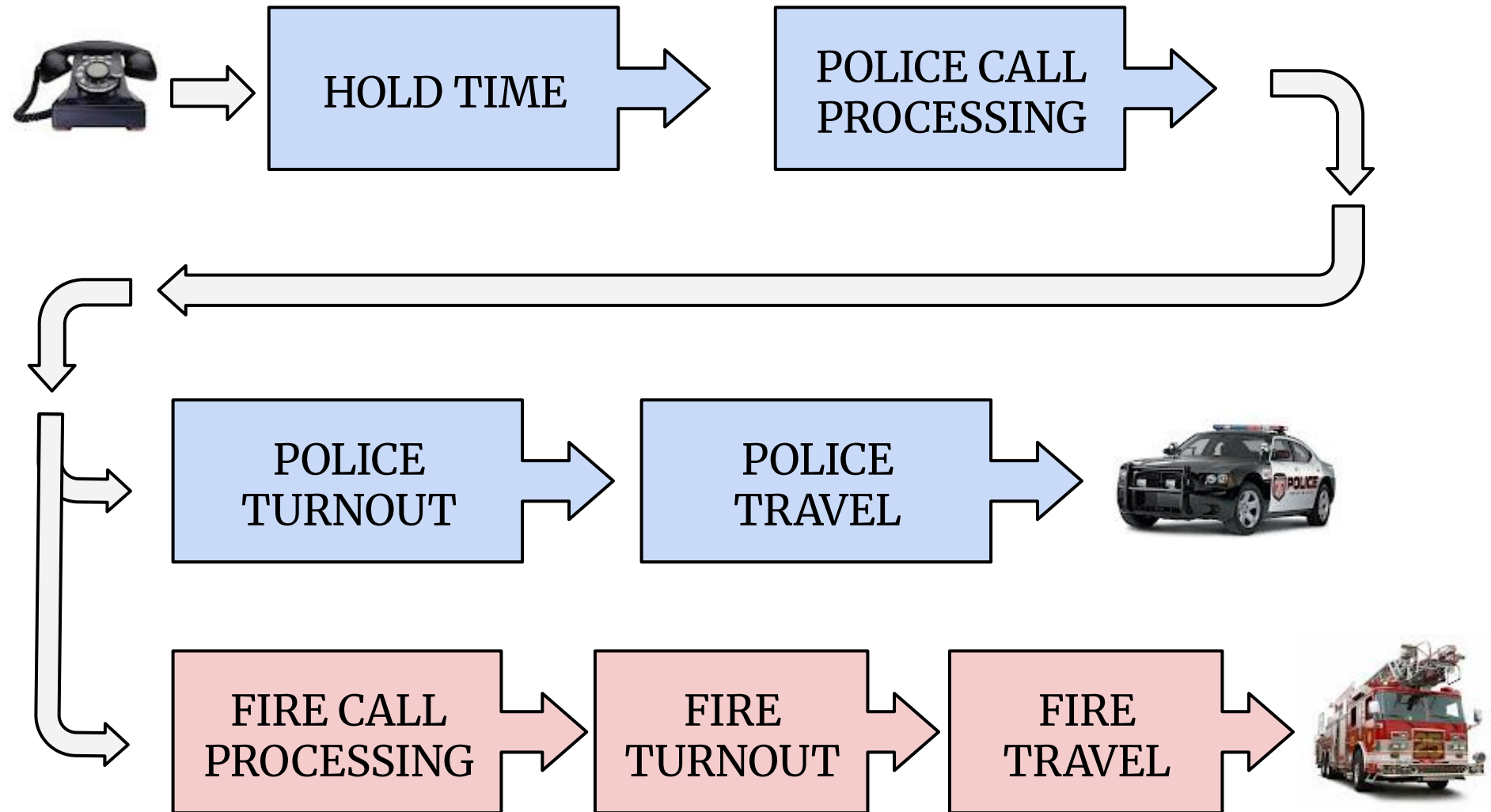


TRAVEL TIME

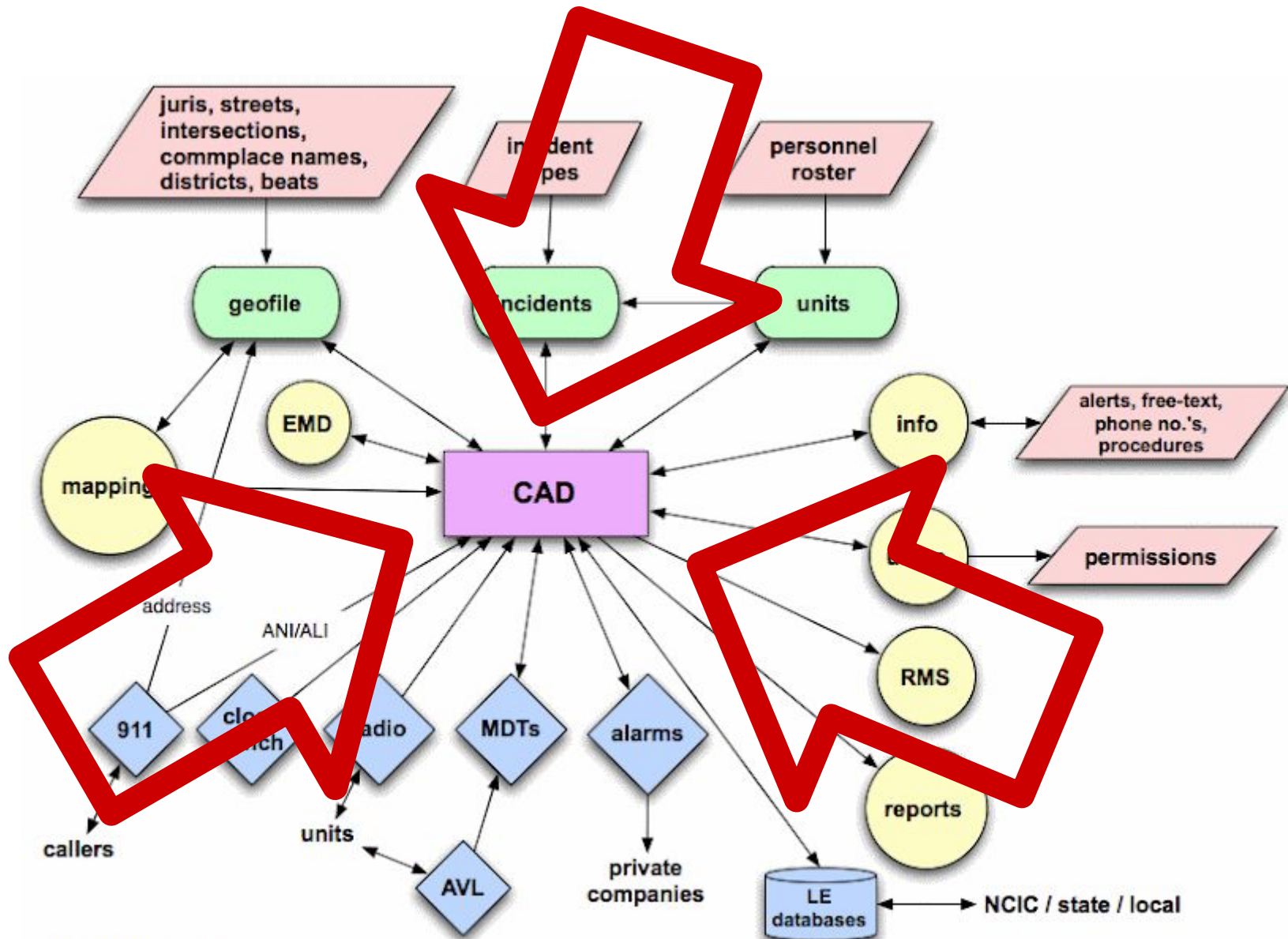
- How long it takes rescuers to drive to the scene.



A REAL-LIFE VERSION



AT THE CORE, A PUBLIC DATABASE



INCIDENT TABLE

- One record per call
- Unique identifier
- Incident type
- Dispatch address
- Lots of timestamps

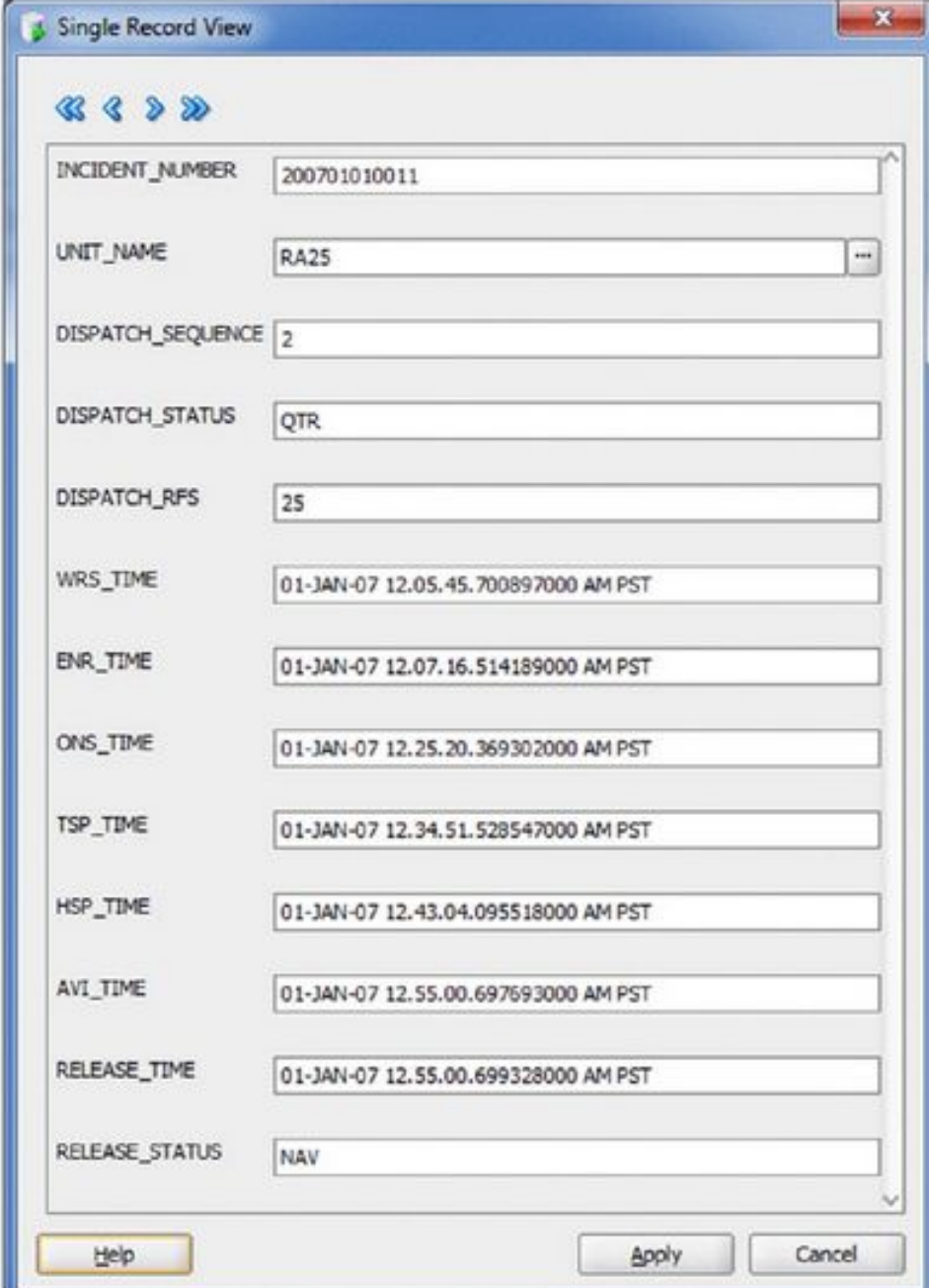
The screenshot shows a 'Single Record View' window with a list of incident fields and their values. The fields are arranged in a vertical list, with some having dropdown menus indicated by three dots. The values are as follows:

Field	Value
INCIDENT_NUMBER	200701010011
INCIDENT_TYPE	6D1A
FLRE_RA_TYPE_IND	RA
ST_NUM	8811
ST_DIRPREF	S
ST_NAME	CENTRAL
ST_TYPE	AV
COMMUNITYCODE	MET
MAP_CD	566.3382
INITIAL_911_TIME	01-JAN-07 12.04.17.000000000 AM PST
CREATION_TIME	01-JAN-07 12.04.49.000000000 AM PST
PEND_TIME	01-JAN-07 12.05.45.429161000 AM PST
GET_TIME	01-JAN-07 12.14.03.240459000 AM PST
DISPATCH_TIME	01-JAN-07 12.05.45.686607000 AM PST
ONSCENE_TIME	01-JAN-07 12.10.35.214481000 AM PST
LAST_UNIT_TIME	01-JAN-07 12.55.00.712476000 AM PST
TIME_ENDED	01-JAN-07 01.00.10.714576000 AM PST

At the bottom of the window are three buttons: 'Help', 'Apply', and 'Cancel'.

RESPONSE TABLE

- One record per unit
- Many to one with call
- Describes unit type
- More timestamps



A screenshot of a software window titled "Single Record View". The window contains a list of fields and their corresponding values, arranged in a table-like format. The fields are: INCIDENT_NUMBER (200701010011), UNIT_NAME (RA25), DISPATCH_SEQUENCE (2), DISPATCH_STATUS (QTR), DISPATCH_RFS (25), WRS_TIME (01-JAN-07 12.05.45.700897000 AM PST), ENR_TIME (01-JAN-07 12.07.16.514189000 AM PST), ONS_TIME (01-JAN-07 12.25.20.369302000 AM PST), TSP_TIME (01-JAN-07 12.34.51.528547000 AM PST), HSP_TIME (01-JAN-07 12.43.04.095518000 AM PST), AVI_TIME (01-JAN-07 12.55.00.697693000 AM PST), RELEASE_TIME (01-JAN-07 12.55.00.699328000 AM PST), and RELEASE_STATUS (NAV). At the bottom of the window, there are three buttons: "Help", "Apply", and "Cancel".

Field	Value
INCIDENT_NUMBER	200701010011
UNIT_NAME	RA25
DISPATCH_SEQUENCE	2
DISPATCH_STATUS	QTR
DISPATCH_RFS	25
WRS_TIME	01-JAN-07 12.05.45.700897000 AM PST
ENR_TIME	01-JAN-07 12.07.16.514189000 AM PST
ONS_TIME	01-JAN-07 12.25.20.369302000 AM PST
TSP_TIME	01-JAN-07 12.34.51.528547000 AM PST
HSP_TIME	01-JAN-07 12.43.04.095518000 AM PST
AVI_TIME	01-JAN-07 12.55.00.697693000 AM PST
RELEASE_TIME	01-JAN-07 12.55.00.699328000 AM PST
RELEASE_STATUS	NAV

**WHAT'S
YOUR
STANDARD?**



BRANT HOUSTON
Journalism professor

CLEAR STANDARDS



BUT THEY ARE OPTIONAL

HOLD TIME

- How long it takes for a dispatcher to pick up the 911 call.
- NENA 56-005 says 90% of calls should be answered in under 10 seconds



CALL-PROCESSING TIME

- How long it takes the dispatcher to log the incident and send help.
- NFPA 1221 says 90% of fire and medical calls should be dispatched in under 60 seconds



TURNOUT TIME

- How long it takes rescuers to suit up and get ready.
- NFPA 1710 says 90% of medical units should be moving in under 60 seconds.



TRAVEL TIME

- How long it takes rescuers to drive to the scene.
- NFPA 1710 says the first fire or medical unit should arrive in under 4 minutes for 90% of responses.



Do local firefighters
meet the standards?

Are times getting
faster or slower?

Does everybody get
the same service?



You

Professional observer



CAROLYN COLE Los Angeles Times

TECHNICIAN Meichu Chen works the control panel for a news program at New Tang Dynasty Television in New York. The station, owned by a group banned in China, has aggressively pursued Chinese political scandals.

COLUMN ONE

Dispatch lag slows LAFD call response

Operators on average take far longer than the national standard to send rescuers, a Times analysis shows.

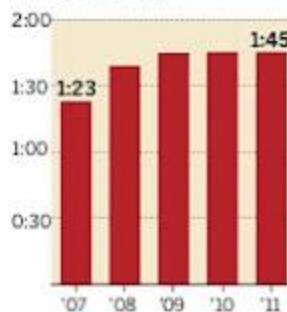
BY BEN WELSH,
ROBERT J. LOPEZ AND
KATE LINTHICUM

When Javier Ortiz collapsed in his backyard in Echo Park, rescuers were stationed in a firehouse just a half-mile away.

But the Los Angeles Fire Department dispatcher who answered the 911 call from Ortiz's daughter took more than 2 1/2 minutes to send the firefighters — nearly three times longer than a national standard for processing calls for help.

Response time

From time Fire Department answers a medical 911 call to dispatch of unit:
(Average, in minutes)



Source: Los Angeles Fire Department

KHANG NGUYEN Los Angeles Times

ers were dispatched to medical calls within a minute 38% of time, the analysis found. By 2011, that number

Sunday

Los Angeles Times

latimes.com

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SUNDAY, OCTOBER 21, 2012

WITHOUT A COUNTRY



DON BARTLETT/Los Angeles Times

LUIS MARTINEZ holds his younger sister Amor during a visit to the river wash where they and their grandmother ended their nearly two-day walk with smugglers who guided them to Nogales, Ariz.

Boundaries hold up L.A. 911 response

City residents often must wait for LAFD rescuers even when county crews could respond faster.

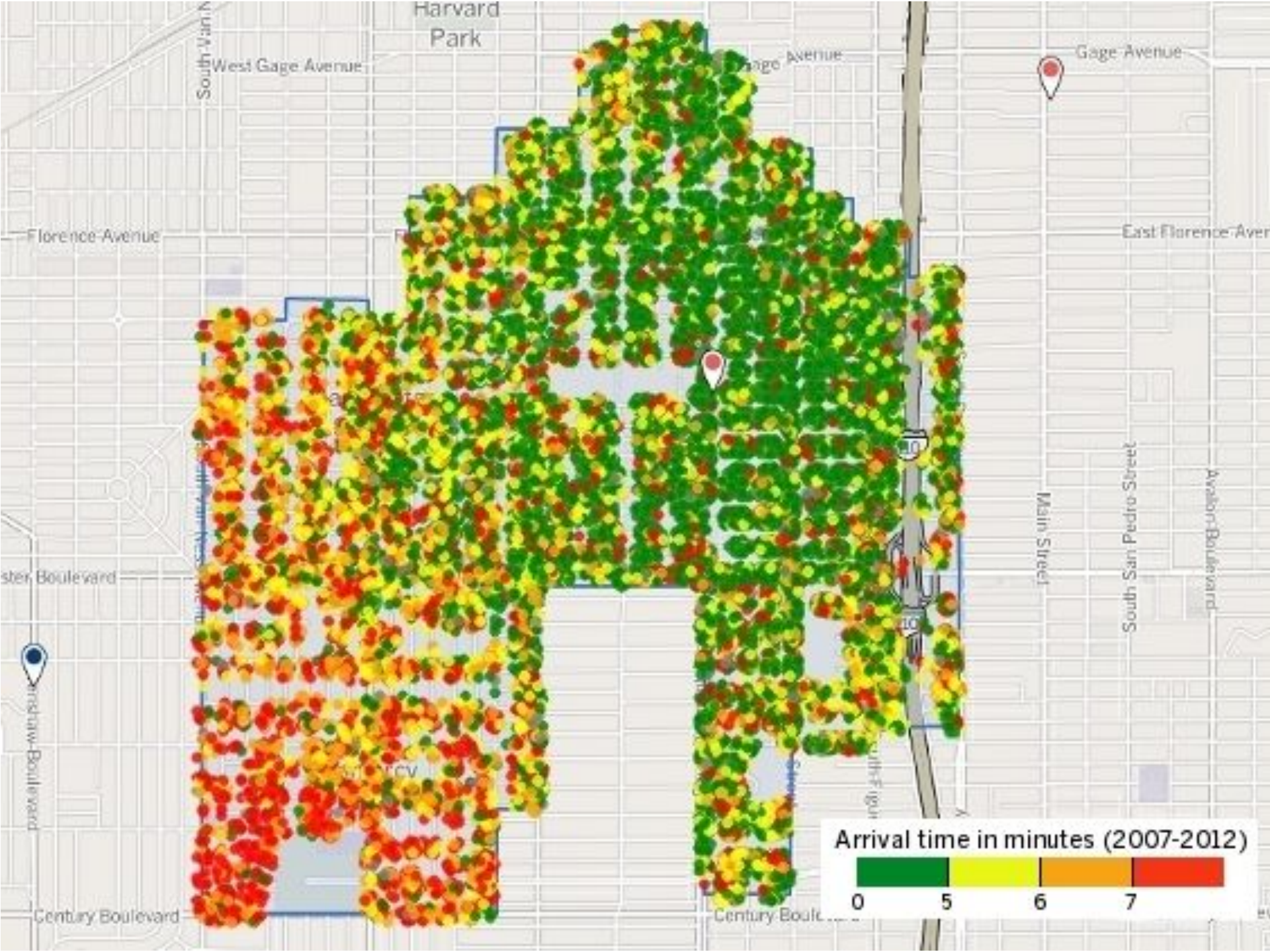
BY ROBERT J. LOPEZ,
BEN WELSH
AND KATE LINTHICUM

Stephanie Hooks pleaded for help after collapsing on the floor of her South Los Angeles home.

"I can't breathe.... Help me breathe!" the 53-year-old grandmother wailed as frantic family members took turns on the phone with a Los Angeles Fire Depart-

utes for LAFD paramedics to reach Hooks, who went into cardiac arrest and died at a hospital. A faster response might not have saved her, but the February 2009 incident highlights a failure to fix how the agency responds to thousands of emergency medical calls along L.A.'s jagged borders despite reforms promised decades ago.

Los Angeles' city and county fire agencies agreed in 1979 to link their dispatching operations to save lives and cut costs. But a Times analysis of more than 1 million LAFD responses over the last five years shows the agency rarely reaches across jurisdictional lines for county help. One result: 911







An aerial photograph showing a residential area. A blue boundary outlines a specific region. Several fire stations are marked with white squares and labeled. The background shows a mix of green grass and brownish ground, possibly a construction site or parking lot.

LAFD Station #57

County Station #173

Hooks home

LAFD Station #64

County Station #170

County Station #14

Pricey home is no guarantee of a quick rescue

BY KATE LINTHICUM,
BEN WELSH
AND ROBERT J. LOPEZ
LOS ANGELES TIMES

Waits for 911 medical aid vary dramatically across Los Angeles and many of the city's most exclusive neighborhoods have the longest response times, according to a Times investigation.

Under national standards adopted by the Los Angeles Fire Department, rescuers are supposed to arrive within six minutes to almost all medical emergencies. But the Times analysis found that in affluent hillside communities stretching from Griffith Park to Pacific Palisades, firefighters failed to hit that mark nearly 85% of the time.

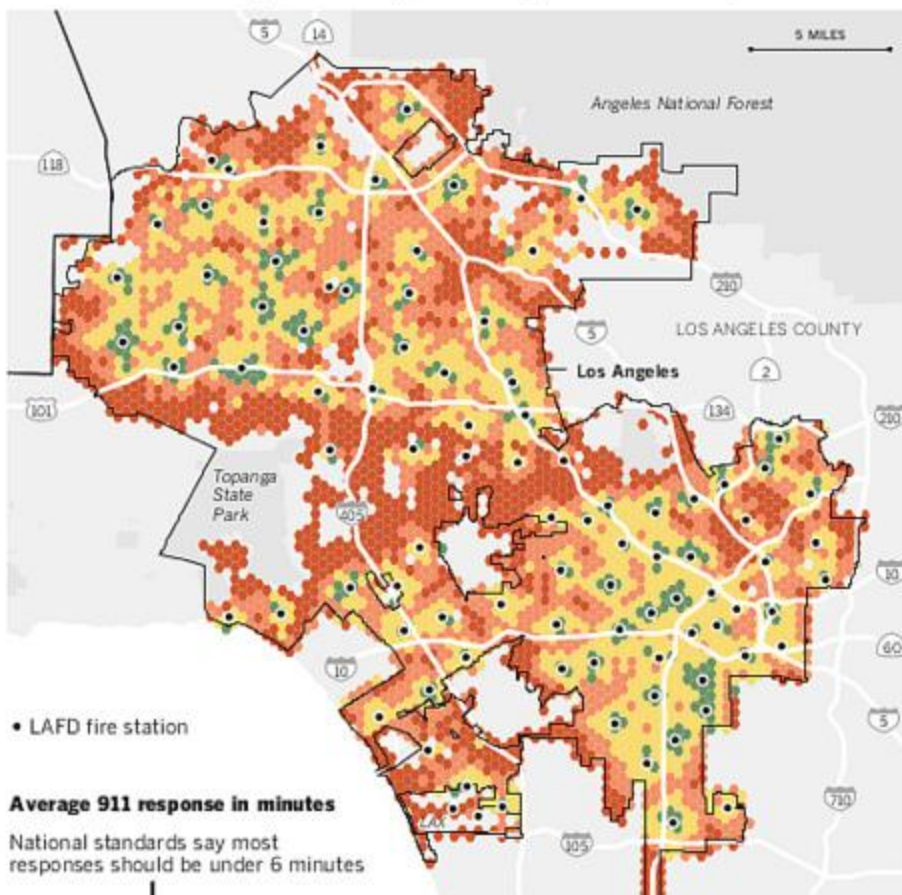
In contrast, rescuers beat the six-minute standard in most of their responses in the more densely populated neighborhoods in and around downtown, where 911 calls are more frequent and the department deploys more resources.

The disparities were also seen in cases of cardiac arrest, one of the most time-sensitive emergencies; brain damage can begin just four minutes after the heart stops beating. Over the last five years, cardiac arrest responses to incidents in Bel-Air have been twice as long as those in the Westlake neighborhood surrounding MacArthur Park, where rescuers arrived on average in just over five minutes.

The Fire Department's

How fast is the LAFD where you live?

Rescuers are expected to arrive to nearly all 911 calls within six minutes, a national standard Los Angeles Fire Department leaders concede they routinely fail to meet. The Times analyzed more than 1 million runs by the Fire Department over the last five years and found that what Angelenos can expect often depends on where they live.



Romney blames loss on Obama 'gifts'

He says the president gave 'a lot of stuff' in his first term to young people and minorities to secure their votes.

BY MAEVE RESTON

Mitt Romney said Wednesday that his loss to President Obama was due in large part to his rival's strategy of giving "gifts" during his first term to three groups that were pivotal in the results of last week's election: African Americans, Latinos and young voters.

"The Obama campaign



INTERACTIVE MAP

How fast is LAFD where you live?

An analysis by the [Los Angeles Times Data Desk](#)

202 South Spring Street, Los Angeles, CA 90012, USA

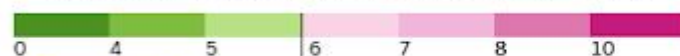
GO

Rescuers are expected to arrive to nearly all 911 calls within six minutes, a national standard LAFD leaders concede they routinely fail.

The Times analyzed more than a million runs by the Fire Department over the last five years and found that what Angelenos can expect often depends on where they live. You can read about the causes and patterns [in the Times story](#).

Use this map to compare the LAFD's performance across L.A.

Average full 911 response in minutes (2007-2012)



[National standards](#) say most responses should be under 6 minutes

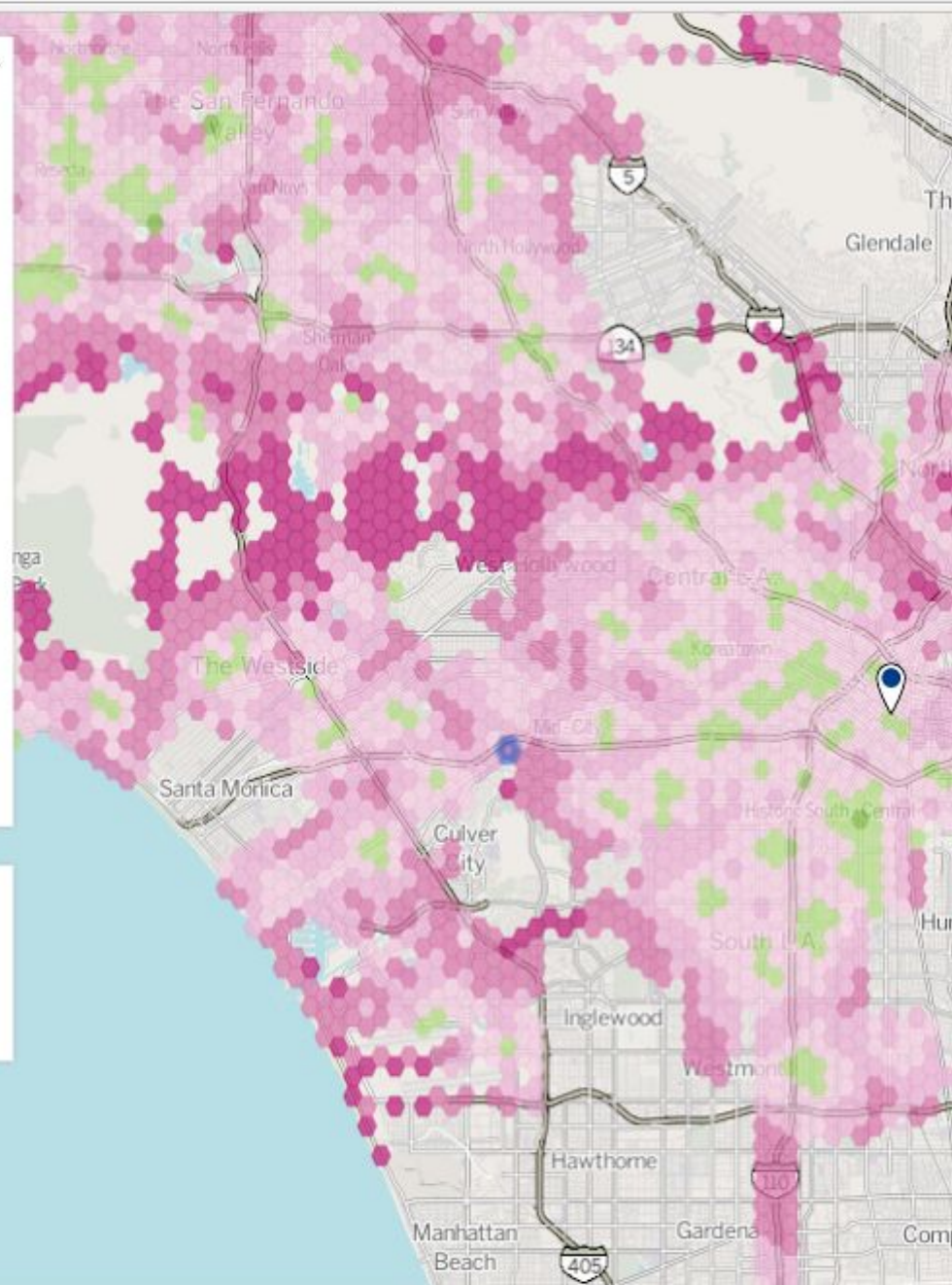
From 2007-2012:

407 total responses

Medical 91.9% Fire 8.1%

8 min., 5-second average response

Avg. dispatch 1:34 Avg. arrival 6:31
125 seconds slower than national standards



Time isn't everything



Most calls are not emergencies

Grandma gets lonely

GENERIC FIRE CHIEF

Anytown, USA

FOCUS ON CARDIAC ARRESTS

- Only ~2% of medical calls, but everyone agrees time imperative
- Brain death can begin after as little as four minutes
- Recent push for increased speed from scientists and doctors



Los Angeles Times

\$1.00 DESIGNATED AREAS HIGHER 78 PAGES © 2012 WST

FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 14, 2012

latimes.com



YAHYA ARHAB European Pressphoto Agency

A YEMENI BURNS a mock U.S. flag as hundreds storm the American Embassy in Sana. Attacks on U.S. missions have created a deepening crisis as America struggles to ease tension in the Middle East.

NEWS ANALYSIS

‘Arab Spring’ shows its thorns

Fire dispatch script blamed for CPR delays

A new LAFD study raises concerns about number of questions operators are required to ask 911 callers.

BY ROBERT J. LOPEZ,
BEN WELSH AND
KATE LINTHICUM

Los Angeles Fire Department dispatchers waste valuable time getting 911 callers to start CPR on cardiac arrest victims, often beginning the life-saving procedure after the point at which brain death begins, according to an internal study obtained by The Times.

The study raised particular concerns about time-consuming scripted questions dispatchers are required to ask, including one

CPR assistance

A study found that LAFD dispatchers were taking too long to help callers start performing CPR.

Elapsed time after call pickup (in minutes and seconds)

To start CPR (average)

4:12

To start CPR (minimum/maximum)

:32

7:36

Elapsed time after heart stops (in minutes and seconds)

Until brain damage can begin

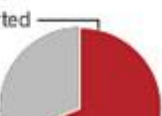
4:00

Percent of calls in which CPR was not started

CPR not started
69%

CPR started

31%



YOU NEED A TEAM



@LAJourn
Investigative reporter,
nightblogger



@katelinthicum
City Hall beat writer,
fears no deadline

AND A FEW RABBIS



INSIDER DATA GEEKS

Every database has quirks,
they know them



REAL FIREFIGHTERS

They live where your data
meets reality

THE END

All materials at palewi.re/talks



"RESPONSE TIMES DON'T MATTER"

(And other
excuses police will
make)

By Ben Poston





- Let's say you get police response time data
- Your PD will likely say response times don't matter.
- They will say that they are not a good measure on which to judge a PD's performance.

How come?



Research done in the 1970s and 1980s that showed that a rapid police response to calls for service only makes a difference on crimes in progress and victims often don't report crimes right away.

The research suggested that just rushing to calls depletes valuable resources that could be used for crime prevention.

Milwaukee PD: A case study

- MPD crime numbers had declined for 4 straight years
- We heard skepticism from every corner of the community
- I wanted to get behind the numbers

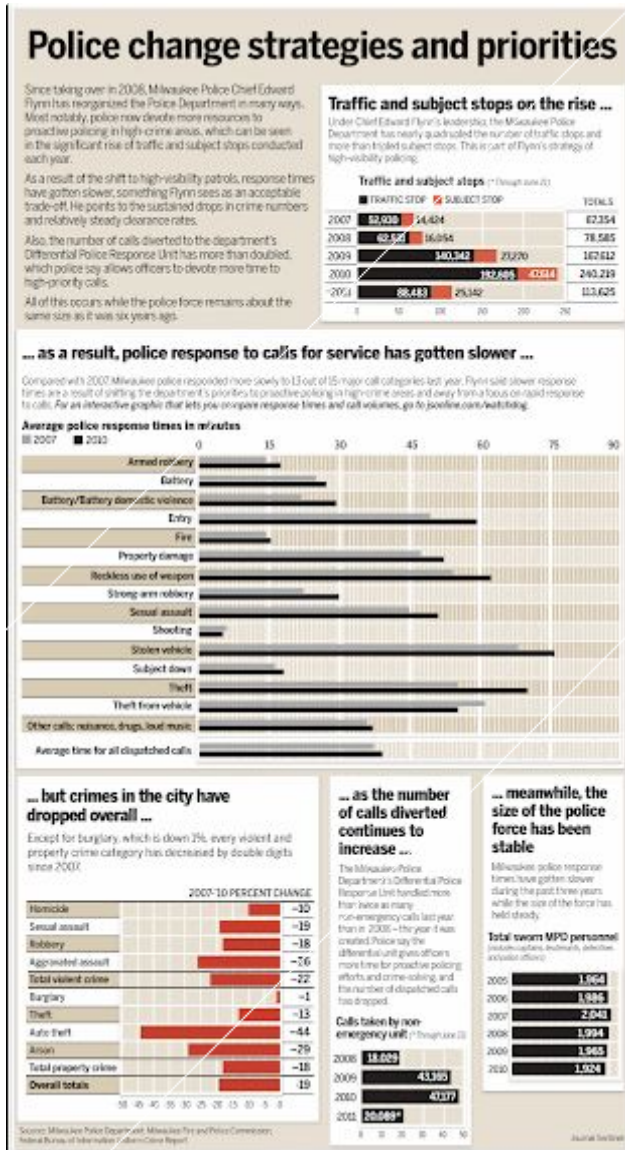


Response times lag as strategy shifts

I reported response times were 10% slower on average and they had gotten slower in 13 of 15 major categories.

Examples: Officers took more than 2 hours to respond to a fatal car crash, 45 minutes for a fatal stabbing and more than a half-hour for an armed robbery

Residents complained that cops don't respond at all to minor crimes like theft from auto, drug dealing, graffiti, and loud music.



Police response: "Meh"



The department's take:
Response times don't matter that much.

"Since the average resident of this city is willing to wait four hours for the cable guy and half a day for a furniture delivery, it seems to me a reasonable delay in responding for a call is an acceptable balance," the police chief said.

That's not all that changed ...

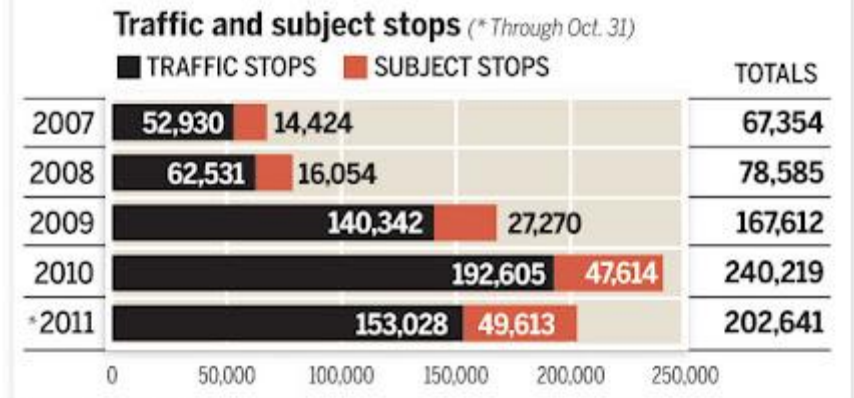
The department's entire strategy had shifted from a reactive strategy to more of a proactive one.

Less focus on rapid response and instead quadrupled the number of cars stops and tripled the number of subject stops. They were all about "high visibility policing."

The police said this deployment shift was a key driver to their declining crime numbers

Traffic and subject stops on the rise

Under Chief Edward Flynn, the Milwaukee Police Department nearly quadrupled the number of traffic stops and more than tripled subject stops since 2007. Traffic stop figures through October show the department is on pace to make a similar number of stops this year.



Source: Milwaukee Police Department

Journal Sentinel

Calls are prioritized

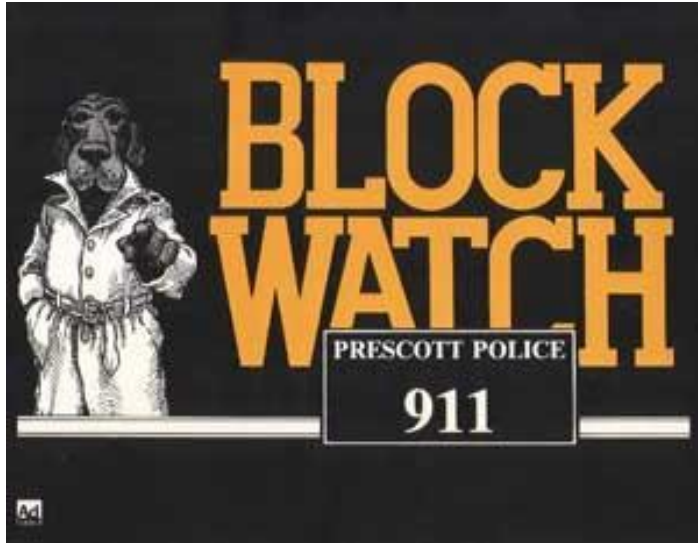


Like most big-city PDs, Milwaukee police now prioritize their calls, using a system from Priority 1 to 5. For minor calls like loud music and drug dealing, police often take reports over the phone or send an officer the next day to prioritize.

They called it the **differential police response unit**.

In Milwaukee, the number of these had more than doubled in 3 years, raising lots of questions.

Tips for reporting on police response times



Hit the meetings: go to neighborhood watch block meetings.

This is where people complain every week about crime and poor police responses.

Residents also complained about feeling harassed by police dispatchers – they claimed they bullied them or talked them out of reporting a crime.

Spend a night in a hood:

I had been talking to resident Thom Reed, who lived in a high-crime neighborhood. The things he told me were hard to believe, so I went out to see it myself.

In one six-hour period, I witnessed shots fired and drug dealing. It helped me write with authority and add color to [a follow-up piece.](#)



Differential police response units

Giving a lower priority to less serious calls makes sense, but this policy upset residents more than anything.

Most people have expectation of seeing a police cruiser when they call 911. After a few hours, they get frustrated and give up and this colors their view of police.

Skeptics claimed that police used the DPRs to slough off crime, though we never could prove that.



KNOW YOUR DATA



I initially got police response time data and realized later that it was from time entered to dispatched, but didn't capture the time to arrive on scene, making the times seem faster.

GET THE RAW DATA



We got aggregated data for the 2011 stories, but later got the raw CAD data that allowed us to dig deeper for trends. You can also use that call data to populate an interactive maps of calls.

Track crime through the criminal justice system



CAD data is the very beginning of the process.

With police CAD data, you can request the associated incident report number. This would allow you to see how often police create a report by call type and overall.

You can also see how often police flag calls as nuisance calls.



LINK 'EM UP!

If you were so inclined, you could then link those incident reports up with crime data if your police department is a NIBRS agency or collects incident-level data.

From there, you merge that data with your District Attorney's case management data (assuming your DA is not living in the stone ages, which many are).